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Hiring Team, AI & Digital Capabilities, Gatorade, PepsiCo

GEO is going to matter more than SEO within two years, and most brands are not ready. When a consumer asks an AI assistant "what's the best electrolyte drink for a marathon," the answer does not come from a Google SERP anymore. It comes from a model that has ingested your site's structured data, your taxonomy, your FAQ accuracy, and your content authority, and then decided whether Gatorade or a competitor is the answer it surfaces. The brand that wins this transition is the one that treats its owned platform as AI training material, not just a consumer destination. That requires someone who understands both how AI models consume content and how to operationalize that understanding into daily site updates, taxonomy changes, and testing agendas.

I built an AI product this year. Not "I use ChatGPT." I wrote production code against the OpenAI API in Python: prompt engineering, structured output parsing, automated content generation pipelines. SwipeHire is a two-sided AI marketplace that tailors content dynamically per user input. The experience taught me exactly how AI models process, rank, and surface content, which is the technical foundation your GEO strategy needs translated into practical site execution.

Three other things from the JD that line up directly:

Owned-platform operations at production cadence. At GenY I owned D2C platform ops end-to-end: Shopify, WordPress, Google Merchant Center, Meta Catalog, seasonal content calendar, product feed hygiene, on-time asset deployment. 16x ROAS. At Plug Power I built the CRM and lifecycle stack from scratch (HubSpot email automation, Salesforce pipeline, segmentation logic) and owned the execution cadence. These are the same muscles as "own the Gatorade.com calendar, ensure all imagery, tiles, and content are accurate, approved, and delivered on schedule."

Cross-functional calendar ownership. At Sensata I manage a 100+ feature backlog in Agile across product, engineering, sales, and 3 regional teams. I lead the sprint cadence, force launch-readiness alignment, and cut time-to-market 20%. Running a weekly cross-functional Gatorade.com calendar meeting with accountability and on-time execution is the same coordination muscle at a different tempo.

Testing and learning as a system. A/B testing is my default operating mode. I ran 8+ structured experiments on SwipeHire activation flows (+25% lift), holdout incrementality tests at Pixis, and creative/audience variants at Plug Power (-25% CPA). Your JD asks for "testing and learning agendas that evolve Gatorade.com as AI search behaviors change." That is not a research project. That is an operating cadence, and it is how I already work.

I hold four Claude AI certifications (Claude 101, Code 101, Cowork, Building with Claude API) alongside an MS in Marketing Analytics (Simon, U. of Rochester) and a BE in Mechanical Engineering (BITS Pilani). Based in Boston, open to Chicago.

Resume and portfolio: adhithyabhaskar.vercel.app/ref/pepsico

Would love 15 to 20 minutes to hear how the AI & Digital Capabilities team is thinking about the GEO transition right now.

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